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From rural corner, Senate rivals emerged

Maine's Aroostook County shaped Collins and Jackson. Now they face off in key race.

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

CARIBOU, Maine — Here, his family logged the woods for generations; hers ran a lumber mill for generations.

Here, he grew up learning to rage against the system; she learned how to be a steward of it.

There is no understanding either Troy Jackson or Susan Collins, as different as they are, without understanding the place that indelibly shaped both of them — and launched them along paths that are now colliding in an epic US Senate campaign.

For both candidates, and for the 66,000-some people who call it home,

Aroostook County is a place of deep roots and a distinct sense of identity. Physically and culturally removed from “downstate,” with sweeping potato fields instead of pine trees and lobster boats, the county is so singular within Maine that it is simply just known as “the County.”

It's not an obvious stage for a political drama with massive stakes, but there are plenty of reasons why this place, roughly the combined size of Connecticut and Rhode Island, has

produced two rivals whose experiences there nurtured ambitions reaching far beyond its borders.

Generations of Collinses, from the town of Caribou, have welcomed generations of County residents through the doors of their hardware and lumber stores. With success, members of the family were taught, came a duty to serve the community — an ethic that fueled the political rises of Susan Collins as well as her predecessors.

SENATE, Page A10

Tough task finding Birchmore trial jurors

Ex-detective accused of killing woman; judge hopes to start case Friday

By Laura Crimaldi and Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

In the high-profile James “Whitey” Bulger case, federal court officials cast a wide net and summoned 858 people to find a jury for the notorious Boston crime boss's trial. Similarly, it took two months and a pool of more than 1,200 people to sit a jury for the death penalty trial of Boston Marathon bomber Dzhokhar Tsarnaev.

On Tuesday, the same process will begin at the federal courthouse in the Seaport for Matthew Farwell, the former Stoughton police detective who will stand trial on charges of killing Sandra Birchmore and staging it to look like a suicide.

Chief US District Court Judge Denise J. Casper signaled Friday that the task won't be as daunting as it was for Bulger and Tsarnaev, and that opening statements could occur as soon as Friday. But Farwell's case is also the first high-profile trial to occur since a jury deadlocked last month over Lindsay Clancy. The intense scrutiny of jurors that followed could complicate the selection process here, legal analysts said.

“Nobody really likes getting a summons in the mail to serve on a jury,” said Alan Tuerkheimer, a jury consultant in Chicago. “A lot of this attention, I think, is going to make jurors who are already reluctant to go serve on a jury a little less willing to do so.”

Farwell, 40, is accused of strangling Birchmore, a young pregnant woman he allegedly began sexually exploiting after meeting her when she was a teenager in a youth police Explorers program and he was a police officer and program in-

FARWELL, Page A6



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

With an expansive mural as a backdrop, Mark Chase, founder of neighborwaysdesign, took a spin on the reimagined Tufts Street in Somerville late last month.

A Somervillian shift in approach: The Anti-Autobahn

Congested city turns drivers' shortcut into a mini obstacle course

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE

For years, cars driving onto Tufts Street had it easy. A gently curved entrance allowed for a smooth turn that gave way to a wide, linear road stretching about 1,000 feet parallel with McGrath Highway, with just some narrow sidewalks on either side.

It was the way you would build it if you wanted to make it as easy as possible to drive.

But that is no longer what the densest city in New England wants.

Today, this section of pavement in East Somerville hardly looks like a road at all. Renovations underway since summer 2025 and set to wrap up in the coming days include all-new signage and pavement markings, speed humps, windy curbs, and artificially narrow sections — capped off by a mammoth new mural that is several hundred feet wide — that give it the feel of something else entirely.

It's a “neighborway,” one of several experiments in extreme street makeovers in Somerville as the city tries to prevent deadly crashes on its roads by intentionally making it harder to drive on them. The result: Side

streets become more comfortable routes for people who aren't traveling by car, and the risk posed by too many cars going too fast is reduced.

“Think about everything everybody knows about the interstate highway system. Curvilinear geometry and wide lanes are designed for cars and trucks to move fast,” said Brad Rawson, Somerville's director of transportation and infrastructure.

Somerville, on this street, tried to do the opposite.

“Tight corners, narrow geometry, narrow lanes are designed to slow down traffic,”

NEIGHBORWAY, Page A7

Healey cuts electric fee, boosts home heating aid

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

EVERETT — Tens of thousands of families who will rely on heating oil to stay warm this winter could receive nearly \$700 to help ease their bills under a slate of mostly temporary and one-time steps Governor Maura Healey announced Monday, declaring that Massachusetts is facing an “energy emergency” amid rising prices and ongoing war abroad.

The executive order Healey signed comes as she faces reelection in less than a month, when many voters could be sizing up whether she's done enough to pare back escalating costs. Under her order, Healey said she is seeking to expand heating assistance for low-income residents, offer new aid to “middle-income” residents, and temporarily remove a charge on electricity bills designed to support solar projects across Massachusetts.

UTILITIES, Page A6

SEEKING MOOSE, FINDING BEAUTY



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

Chris Young gives out a call of a cow moose, trying to attract a bull. Young is an expert at such calls and these days are ideal to find a moose in mating season in Northern Maine. **As I See It, B1.**

Listed as ray to ray

Tuesday: Lots of wind, High 60-65, low 43-48.

Wednesday: More sun. High 65-70, low 53-58.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**

A mother and son, both Bermuda citizens, were identified as two of the victims of the apparent crash of a medical transport flight near Nantucket. **B1.**

Several soldiers injured in a devastating drone attack in

Kuwait contend the military did not heed warnings that the site was vulnerable and then faltered on promptly addressing their injuries. **A5.**

A Boston native was among three scientists awarded the Nobel Prize in medicine. **A4.**

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